

Prize winners of '64'

By C.G.S.Narayanan

'64' is well known monthly Russian problem magazine with quality chess compositions. The recent issue brings out results of problems of 2025 in all genres with comments by grandmaster Alexandr Kuzovkov. In the two-move section twenty problems were awarded prizes including three miniatures that received special distinctions. This article presents a few from the award.

A.Siesarenko
First prize, '64' 2025



Mate in two moves

1...Nxd4(a) 2.Qg3(X)# (Qe3?),
1..Ng5(b) 2.f7#, 1.Rf4? ~ 2.Rf5#,
1..Nd4(a) 2.Qxd4#, 1...Kxf4(c)
2 Qg 3 (X), 1.... Bx e 6 /Be4
1...Re4(Y)#, 1...Ne3! **1.Nb3!** ~
1. Re4(Y)#, 1...Nxd4(a) 2.Qe3#
(Qxd4?), 1...Ng5(b) 2.Qg3(X)#
(f7?), 1...Kxe6 2.e8Q#. 1.N5~? Ng5!

"Marjan Kovacevic's idea is a double checkmate (X) with an additional change in play and move functions,. I am always attracted to problems where you have to choose exactly which mate to give. And that is exactly what this composition is like – before giving mate, you have to think. The second phase and the solution, which gives the black king a free square, also embellish the problem."(A.Kuzovkov)

Marjan Kovacevic
3 prize, '64' 2025



Mate in two moves

1.Nxe6? 2.Ng7, 1...Nc~ 2.Re5
(2.Nd4?)1...Ra7!
1.Rxe6?(Rf6) 1...Nc~ 2.Qe5
(2.Re5?) Nd5! 1.Nxh5?2 .Ng7
1...Rh1 2.Bg4(2.Ng3!)
Key 1.Bxh5!(2 .Bg6),
1...Rh1 Qg4 (2.Bg4?),
1...Ne7/Ne5 2.R(x)e5#,
1...Bxe4 2.Qxe4[.gxf4 2.Rxf4.

Four thematic variations with an anti- dual choice of mate against a backdrop of hidden pins. Two variations also feature the Bristol theme. The absence of white pawns is always impressive.

A two mover for solving
M.Kuzmichev
Spl.Mention, '64' 2025



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in "A Burmistrov combination": **1.Le4!**
[2.Se2#].For full solution with comments visit wfcc.com

Readers may send in their queries to
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